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VNR VIGNANA JYOTHI INSTITUTE OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY

(AUTONOMOUS)

III B.Tech. I Semester 2nd Sessional Examinations, January 2024

PROFESSIONAL ETHICS AND HUMAN VALUES

(Common To All Branches)

Time: 90 Minutes **Date of Examination: 06.Jan.2024** **Max. Marks: 24 Marks**

PART-A

I. Answer all the following: **3 × 2 Marks = 6 Marks**

1. What is an occupational crime? Give an example.	CO-4	BL-1
2. Define safety and risk.	CO-3	BL-1
3. List four ethical aspects that leaders of MNCs must consider when operating in different countries.	CO-1	BL-2

PART-B

II. Answer one question from each unit. **3 × 6 Marks = 18 Marks**

UNIT-IV

1. In an episode of the Amazon original series titled "Guilty Minds", a group of music directors decides to file a case against a person who built a piece of software, an AI model called "Aalaap", which trains itself from the records of publicly available audio songs to create new music. Music directors, who find some bits of their old tunes in the new songs created thus, file a case against the creator of Aalaap and win the case with the judge ruling that "*Aaalaap songs are plagiarised and it should be boycotted*". Considering technology, Aalaap is a neural network that learns from existing content that is publicly available and its creator argues that it is thus not plagiarism. CO-2 BL-3

   Do you agree with the judgement? AI brings in a lot of such issues, where the creators are not really copying anyone else's work but a software is using some others' work to learn. Do you consider it a culpable mistake? Are professional ethics violated and professional responsibilities ignored here? Justify your answers for all the three questions here. You may use suitable ethical theories or theories of right action to justify your answers.

(OR)

2. Define whistleblowing. Give examples of conflicts of interest in an organisation. Is there a conflict of interest for a manager in an organisation when he/ she encounters an act of whistleblowing? Justify your answer. CO-4 BL-3

UNIT-V

3. In the wake of the COVID-19 turning into a pandemic, pharma companies around the world tried developing and producing vaccines against the viral infection. The UN-backed global vaccine supply initiative, "COVAX", was started with a goal of delivering 2 billion doses by the end of 2021 but could deliver only 1 billion by January 2022. As of October 2021, only 0.7% of all manufactured vaccine doses had gone to low-income countries, while high-income countries received 47 times more doses! In this situation, it is estimated that Asia and Europe will will be able to fully vaccinate 80% of their populations by March 2022 and North America by May 2022, Africa will not reach 80% at current rates until April 2025. Mentioning these statistics, Salam Alshareef writes thus in the article cited below: "*Intellectual property rights are political creature as they profit specific social interests and were lobbied for by them… Tight intellectual property rights are also counterproductive from a broader economic perspective. Several economists argue that intellectual monopoly capitalism produces economic crisis and stagnation. … The monopolisation of socially produced knowledge by intellectual property rights produces hierarchical relations among firms and between capital and labour, exacerbating inequality and creating a situation where a handful of firms capture the lion's share of global profits.*" (Source: https://theconversation.com/how-the-intellectual-property-monopoly-has-impeded-an-effective-response-to-covid-19-173298) CO-3 BL-3

Do you think the concern about “intellectual monopoly capitalism” valid? Since IP rights are not more important than universal human rights, how can an ethico-economic system avoid such a situation where poor countries do not get the same privileges as a rich country?

(OR)

4. Disasters like those of Titanic, Bhopal, Chernobyl, or Fukushima highlight the need for ethics, particularly among the professionals, but these disasters are huge in size and rare in occurrence. In today’s world of Industry 4.0, technology solutions are people’s first source of help/ information. Disasters with data privacy and violations have been more frequent but have lesser consequences compared to such disasters as above. How should the technology world deal with risks with low consequence and high probability and risks with high consequence and low probability? As an engineer-to-be, how would you think you would deal with these two scenarios? You may use suitable examples (or even put yourself in the shoes of an engineer in one of those disasters or as a developer or a low-risk technology solution) and suitable ethical theories of right action as a guidance through your answer. CO-3 BL-4

UNIT-VI

5. In the film “Leo” directed by Lokesh Kanagaraj, the protagonist in exile aids the Forest Department in rescuing the endangered species. In a particular scene later, the protagonist uses help from the police department in a speedy vehicle chase for a personal cause, even leading to a policeman getting injured. It may be noted that the injured policeman was assigned to him by the police department for security purpose, but the protagonist uses him for a personal agenda. CO-4 BL-4

   In a latest turn of events, one Mr. Raja Murugan has filed a case in Madurai High Court mentioning that some “scenes depict riots, illegal activities, over-speeding of vehicles, and crimes committed with the help of police”, and maintained that “these portrayals are not good for society” and insisted that “the censor board should properly censor such films” and that “Lokesh Kanagaraj should be properly psychologically examined and a case should be registered against him because he continues to shoot violent scenes”. (Source: https://www.indiaglitz.com/case-filed-against-director-lokesh-kanagaraj-in-madurai-high-court-leo-movie-thalaivar-171-latest-tamil-news-348010)

   Do you agree with any or all comments of Mr. Raja Murugan? Do you think creative freedom must consider cultural aspects, ethics, and legalities in its expression? You may use examples of some other recent films and/or OTT series/films where the makers seem to enjoy “limitless (uncensored) freedom”.

(OR)

6. “Delulu is the solulu” is used as a Generation-Z phrase to mean “Delusion is the solution”. Being delusional can create a confidence that you’d not otherwise have and drive you to a solution you’d not have otherwise noticed. Writing an article about this social media trend on forbes.com, psychologist Mark Travers says “*Confidence And Self-Belief Pave The Path To Success” and “Manifestation And Positive Thinking Fuels Your Journey To Growth*” and concludes thus: CO-2 BL-3

   “*The ‘delulu’ mindset reinforces once again the power of belief and self-talk in turning ideas into action with success. As with any social media trend, the deluge of ‘delulu’ needs to be taken with a grain of salt. However, writing it off as just another gen Z whim might come at a cost. It’s not a coincidence that most successful people, when looking back at their younger selves, cite the delusional hope they had back then as the fuel that propelled them through the toughest parts of their lives and careers.*

   It’s not a coincidence that most successful people, when looking back at their younger selves, cite the delusional hope they had back then as the fuel that propelled them through the toughest parts of their lives and careers.” (Source: https://www.forbes.com/sites/traversmark/2023/09/21/is-delulu-really-the-solulu-a-psychologist-explores-the-new-tiktok-trend/?sh=2491a7c27196)

   While delulu is the solulu may be true at least sometimes, how do you ensure that your delusion will not drive you towards unethicality? What prior training of one’s mind is needed to ensure that delusion is not a path away from ethics?